

Global CO₂ Emissions

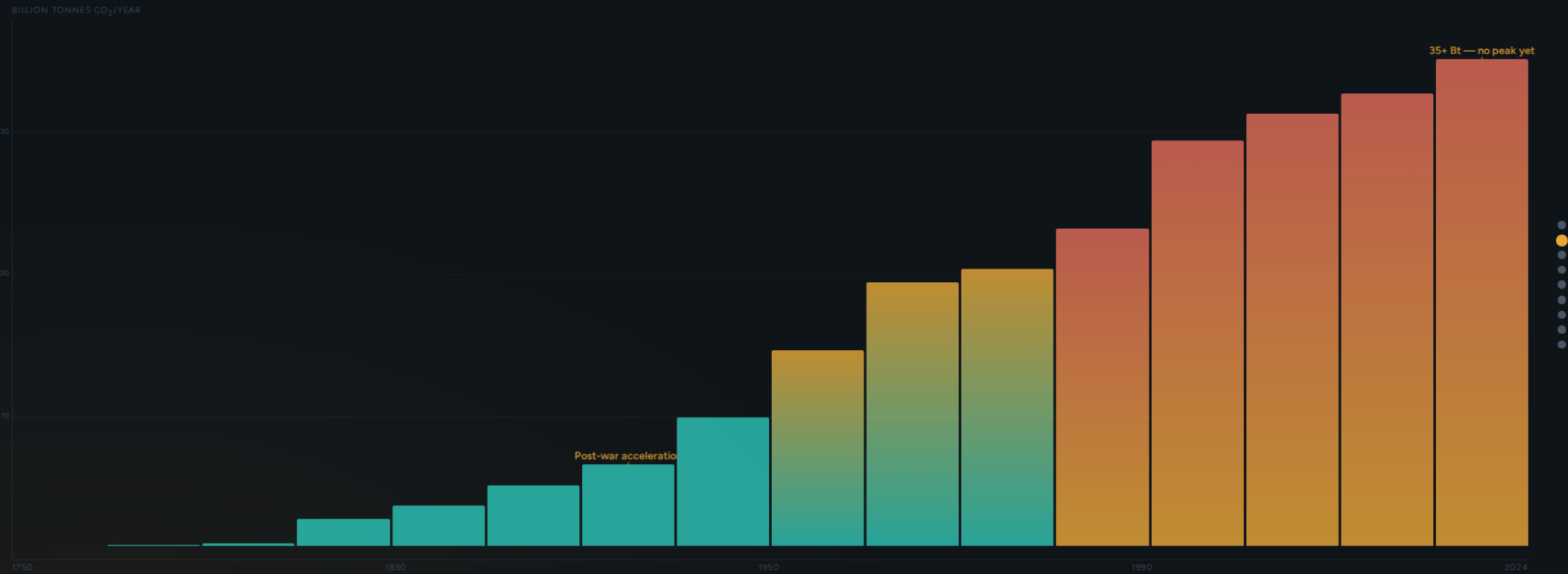
Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

Fossil fuels & industry · 1750–2024

DATA: **GLOBAL CARBON BUDGET 2025** VIA OUR WORLD IN DATA

Global CO₂ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today

Fossil fuel and industry emissions, 1750–2024. Growth has slowed but no peak yet.



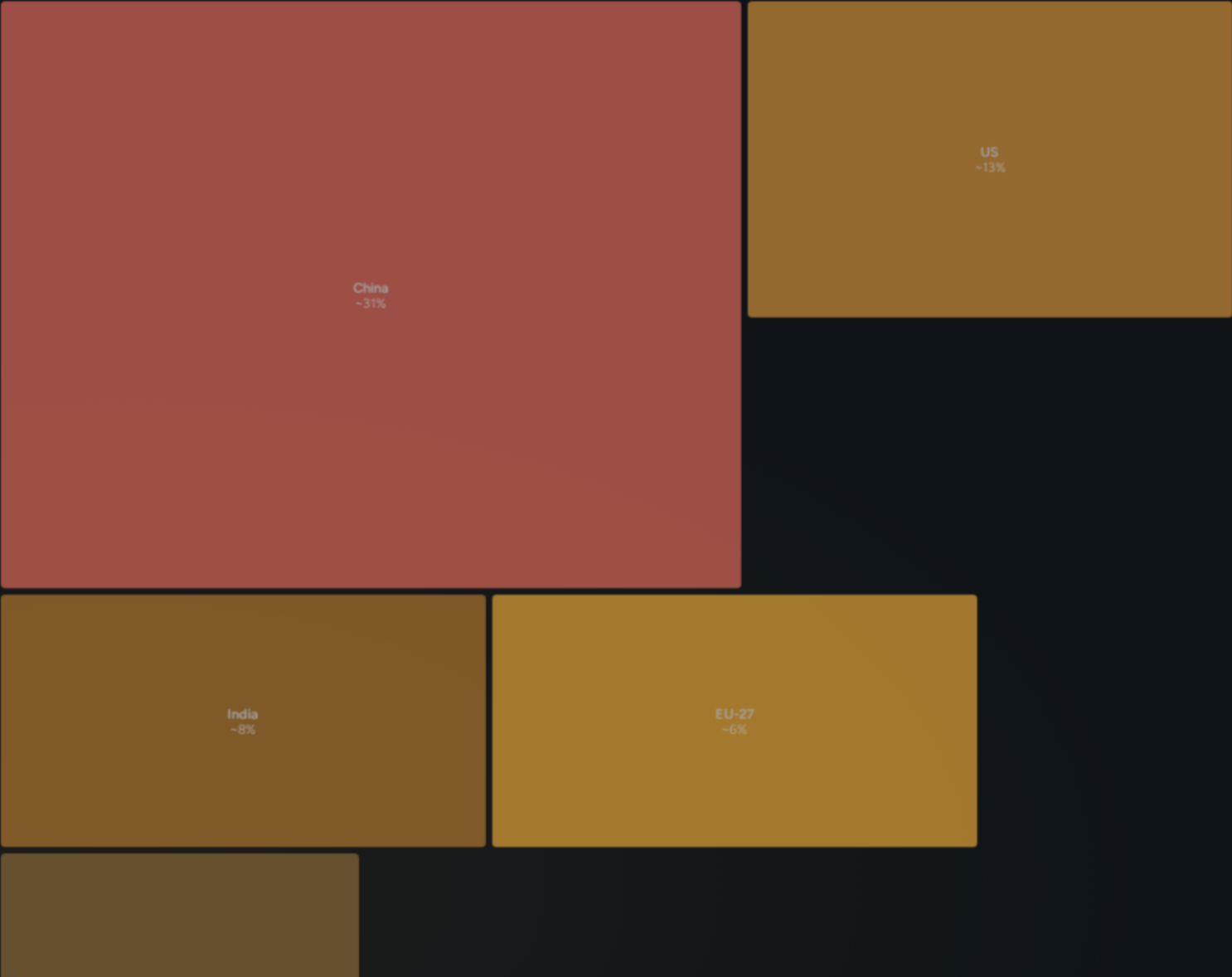
Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third Today

Share of global CO₂ emissions by region, 1900–2024. Asia — led by China — now produces roughly half.



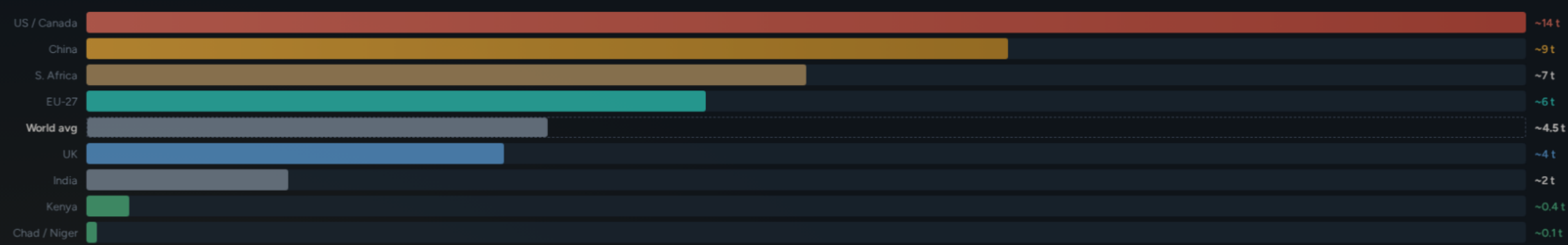
China Now Emits More Than **One-Quarter** of Global CO₂

Country-level share of global CO₂ emissions, 2024. Top four emitters account for ~58%.



Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada

A 150x gap between the lowest and highest emitting nations. The average American emits in under two days what a person in Niger emits in a year.



TONNES CO₂ PER PERSON PER YEAR

150X GAP

Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India

China's per capita emissions remain below the US despite being the largest total emitter. India remains very low.



1.6x gap: US per capita emissions are 1.6x China's, despite China being the largest total emitter

2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia and Africa Grew

Annual percentage change in CO₂ emissions, 2024. Developed nations decline; parts of Asia, Middle East, and Africa increase.



CHART · CHOROPLETH MAP
Blue shading = emissions decline (US, EU, UK) · Orange/red shading = emissions increase (Russia, SE Asia, parts of Africa)

◀ DECLINE

GROWTH ▶

Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany or the US

Among wealthy nations with similar prosperity, per capita emissions vary significantly because of energy mix choices.

Higher Per Capita

United States

~14 t

Fossil-fuel dominant electricity; high car dependence; large homes

Germany

~8 t

Significant coal reliance in electricity generation despite Energiewende

Lower Per Capita

United Kingdom

~4 t

Shifted from coal to gas and renewables; wind power expansion

France

~4 t

Nuclear provides ~70% of electricity — very low-carbon grid

Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

- 1 Global emissions exceed **35 Bt/yr** and haven't peaked — growth has slowed but not reversed
- 2 **China is the largest annual emitter** (~31%) but per capita (~9 t) still below the US (~14 t)
- 3 **Historical responsibility** is dominated by Europe and the US (>90% in 1900, now <30%)